

Copilot Prompt Handout — Session 3

From Data to Deliverables — Teams, Excel, Word & PowerPoint

Audience: Copilot licensed users. Demo files referenced are fictional and provided in the session pack.

How to use this handout

Use these prompts during or after the session to practise common Copilot scenarios. Each is grouped by use case so you can quickly find a starting point.

- Copy a prompt as-is, then adapt the names and details to your own work.
- Add business context when you want a sharper answer (role, audience, what 'good' looks like).
- Always validate facts, figures and wording before you share.

Tip: stronger prompts usually include a goal, context, a source, the output you expect, and a request to validate.

Choosing a prompt by pace — most demos below give a few options: A · Quick (low interaction / short on time) lands the point in one shot. B · Standard (balanced) is the core demo. C · Interactive (high engagement) is multi-part — invite the class to shape the inputs, refine, and compare.

1. Teams — prepare for a meeting

Build the agenda for an upcoming meeting from its invite, the lead-up email thread, and last meeting's minutes. Demo set: the invite (DCE-Demo-Meeting-Invite), the agenda-input email thread (DCE-Demo-Atlas-Agenda-Inputs), and the previous minutes & open actions (DCE-Demo-Atlas-Previous-Minutes-and-Actions).

Option A · Quick — fast agenda

Draft an agenda for the Project Atlas Steering Committee from the meeting invite and the agenda-input email thread.

Option B · Standard — agenda + risks

Using the Project Atlas Steering Committee invite, the agenda-input email thread, and the previous minutes & open actions, draft an agenda, list the key risks and open questions I should raise, and give me a two-line brief on each attendee.

Option C · Interactive — tailor to the outcome

Help me prep for the Project Atlas Steering Committee. From the invite, the agenda-input thread and the previous minutes & open actions, draft an agenda and the top risks, then ask me what outcome I want and tailor the talking points to that.

2. Teams — capture decisions & actions

Turn a recorded meeting into momentum.

Option A · Quick — short recap

Summarize this meeting in five lines and list the decisions and action items with owners.

Option B · Standard — full recap

Summarize this meeting.

Output:

- Key decisions
- Action items (Action | Owner | Due date)
- Risks and mitigations
- Open questions before the next review

Option C · Interactive — recap + follow-up

Recap this meeting: first the decisions and actions with owners, then tell me what is assigned to me, draft a follow-up message to the team, and ask me if I want to adjust the tone before I send it.

3. Excel — explore with natural language

Ask questions of your data; no formulas to remember.

Option A · Quick — one question

Which service lines have the lowest margin this quarter? Show the supporting rows.

Option B · Standard — what's driving it

Which service lines are underperforming on margin and realisation this quarter, and what's driving it? Show the supporting rows.

Option C · Interactive — drill down together

Let's explore this portfolio. Start by showing me the three service lines that need attention, then I'll pick one and we'll drill into the engagements behind it.

4. Excel — clean the data

Fix issues before you analyze.

Option A · Quick — one column

Standardize the Engagement Lead column to Title Case and flag rows where the format looks off.

Option B · Standard — full clean-up

Clean this sheet: standardize Engagement Lead to Title Case, format dates as DD-MMM-YYYY, and flag missing or invalid values. List what you changed.

Option C · Interactive — decide fixes together

Walk me through cleaning this data. First show me the data-quality issues you find (blanks, duplicates, inconsistent formats), then let me decide which to fix and apply them.

5. Excel — trends, outliers & drivers

Find what matters.

Option A · Quick — outliers

Flag every engagement where Budget Variance % is over 10% or Margin % is negative, and

explain in one line why each one stands out.

Option B · Standard — outliers + drivers

Find the outliers and the drivers: flag engagements over 10% budget variance or negative margin, and tell me the top three factors moving margin across the portfolio, each supported by the relevant rows.

Option C · Interactive — choose the lens

Help me find what matters in this portfolio. Surface the trends and outliers, then ask me whether to investigate by service line, region, or engagement lead – and drill into my choice.

6. Excel — pivots, charts & summaries

Make the point clearly.

Option A · Quick — one pivot

Create a PivotTable of Fees by Service Line.

Option B · Standard — pivot + chart + summary

Create a PivotTable of Fees and average Margin % by Service Line and Region, chart Fees by Service Line, and summarize the key insight in two sentences.

Option C · Interactive — build it live

Let's build the analysis live. Start with Fees by Service Line, then I'll ask you to group by region, show the top five, and switch chart types – finish with a two-sentence insight.

7. Validate before you share

You stay accountable for the output.

Option A · Quick — spot-check

Validate this: list the key figures and the exact rows they came from, and flag anything I should double-check.

Option B · Thorough — full validation

Validate your analysis before I share it: list the key figures and their source rows, confirm the time range and filters you used, explain your reasoning, and flag anything risky to put in front of a partner.

8. Word — draft & refine

From recap and data to a clear document.

Option A · Quick — draft

Draft a one-page client-ready summary from this meeting recap and the portfolio insight.

Option B · Standard — draft + improve

Draft a one-page client-ready summary from this recap and the portfolio insight – executive tone, clear headings, under 350 words – then suggest three improvements.

Option C · Interactive — refine together

Help me write this summary. Draft it from the recap and insight, then let's refine together: I'll tell you which section to tighten, change the tone, or expand – and flag any number I should confirm.

9. PowerPoint — storyline & speaker notes

Build the deck and present with confidence.

Option A · Quick — 5 slides

Create a 5-slide deck from this summary with a title, executive summary, performance, risks, and next steps.

Option B · Standard — slides + notes

Create a 5-slide presentation from this summary (title, executive summary, performance, risks, next steps) and add concise speaker notes for each slide.

Option C · Interactive — shape the flow

Let's build the deck. Start with a 5-slide storyline from this summary, then I'll reorder and tighten, and you add speaker notes once we're happy with the flow.